

**Bridging Generations: The Importance and Effectiveness of Intergenerational Programs**

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Loneliness has been an unpreventable emotional state experienced by all people regardless of their personality and age. However, it has become an “epidemic” particularly among the elderly, as they often confront significant changes in both their relationships and lifestyles. One major factor is the loss of loved ones—whether through death, relocation, or gradual social disconnection—which can deeply impact their emotional well-being (Murray-McGinnis, 2024). The absence of close companionship can lead to feelings of isolation and depression, making it challenging for older adults to maintain a sense of belonging and purpose. Another crucial shift occurs with retirement. While retirement is often anticipated as a period of relaxation, it can also result in a sudden loss of routine, social networks, and a sense of identity that was previously shaped by professional roles. Many retirees struggle to find meaningful ways to fill their time, and without consistent social interaction from the workplace, they may experience further isolation.

Additionally, the rapid development of technology has further widened the generational divide. While digital advancements have revolutionized communication and accessibility, older adults may face challenges in keeping up with new technologies, making it harder for them to stay connected with family, friends, and society at large. As many news reported China where life-needed services were digitised in the large scale, the increasing reliance on digital platforms for socialization, services, and even healthcare can leave elderly individuals feeling alienated, especially if they lack the necessary digital literacy skills or access to technology (XiangSheng net, 2022).

Loneliness and social isolation can also lead to physical health issues, including some chronic diseases, such as cardiovascular disease, hypertension, and diabetes, as well as mental health diseases, such as major depression and anxiety (Murray-McGinnis, 2024; Holt-Lunstad, 2021). Thus, given these challenges, intergenerational programs have emerged for an urgent need, providing structured opportunities for meaningful interaction between younger and older generations. By engaging in collaborative activities, mentorship, and shared learning experiences, participants can challenge misconceptions, build mutual respect, and develop a greater sense of community (Winstanely, 2023).

### **Literature Review**

Intergenerational programs (IGPs) are underpinned by established theoretical frameworks that explain their effectiveness. Erikson's lifespan development theory posits that relationships between younger and older individuals fulfill essential psychosocial needs. Older adults benefit from engaging with younger generations by fostering a sense of generativity, while younger participants develop trust and social competence through these interactions (Giraudeau & Bailly, 2019). Similarly, Allport's Contact Theory highlights the importance of structured intergroup interactions in reducing prejudice and promoting positive attitudes between different generations (Jarrott et al., 2021). These theoretical frameworks help decompose the mechanisms that contribute to intergenerational engagement and the mutual benefits it produces.

Empirical research demonstrates the significant benefits of IGPs for older adults. Studies indicate that participation in structured intergenerational activities reduces loneliness and social isolation by strengthening interpersonal connections and reducing depressive symptoms (Pinazo-Hernandis & Carrascosa, 2024). Furthermore, engaging in collaborative activities

enhances cognitive function, emotional resilience, and self-esteem, ultimately improving overall well-being (Gualano et al., 2018). Older adults who participate in mentorship programs experience an increased sense of purpose, as these roles allow them to contribute knowledge and support to younger generations, ultimately fostering a renewed sense of meaning in their lives (Jarrott et al., 2021). These positive outcomes emphasize the critical role that intergenerational programs play in enhancing the quality of life for older individuals, particularly those in underserved communities where opportunities for social engagement may be limited.

For younger participants, intergenerational programs serve as an effective tool for reducing age-related stereotypes and fostering an appreciation for older generations. Studies suggest that structured exposure to older individuals helps children develop more positive attitudes toward aging, enhances their understanding of the aging process, as well as increases the awareness of the challenges and contributions of older adults (Banks et al., 2024). Intergenerational programs also enhance emotional and social learning, which help facilitate children with stronger emotional regulation skills, increased empathy, and improved interpersonal communication (Martins et al., 2019; Banks et al., 2023). Younger generations with limited communication with multi-generations often have trouble showing empathy to older generations so these skills from these programs can be helpful in closing that gap. Furthermore, educational and mentorship programs within intergenerational initiatives have been linked to higher levels of student engagement and motivation, which demonstrate the far-reaching impacts of these initiatives beyond just social interactions (Giraudeau & Bailly, 2019). The ability to connect with older adults in meaningful ways provides young participants with role models, exposing them to diverse perspectives and life experiences that contribute to their personal growth.

Effective intergenerational programs employ specific strategies to maximize their impact. Structured facilitation, with well-trained staff and clear objectives, enhances social benefits and attitudinal shifts by ensuring meaningful exchanges between participants (Jarrott et al., 2021). Programs that incorporate collaborative arts, shared storytelling, and skill-sharing workshops foster deeper emotional connections and create a platform for shared learning (Banks et al., 2024). Additionally, intergenerational programs that integrate technology, such as digital literacy initiatives where younger participants teach older adults, have been particularly successful in bridging generational gaps (Pinazo-Hernandis & Carrascosa, 2024). These programs not only improve technological proficiency among older adults but also facilitate cross-generational collaboration and learning. Tailoring programs to the specific needs of communities further enhances their effectiveness and sustainability, ensuring that participants experience meaningful engagement (Gualano et al., 2018).

Despite their numerous advantages, intergenerational programs face several challenges in implementation and evaluation. Many studies rely on small sample sizes and lack rigorous experimental designs, limiting the generalizability of their findings (Martins et al., 2019). Additionally, there is a growing need for longitudinal research to assess the long-term impact of intergenerational interactions on both younger and older participants, because most existing studies focus on short-term effects (Jarrott et al., 2021). Another critical issue is that poorly structured programs may reinforce stereotypes or infantilize older participants, which thereby lead to the deviation from the effects of positive intention (Gualano et al., 2018). These challenges highlight the need for continued research and careful program design to ensure that intergenerational initiatives remain impactful and beneficial for all participants involved.

In summary, the literature underscores the substantial benefits of intergenerational programs in fostering social inclusion, reducing stereotypes, and enhancing emotional and cognitive wellbeing for both younger and older participants. These programs not only mitigate social isolation among older adults but also provide meaningful learning experiences for younger generations. However, their effectiveness depends on strategic implementation, structured facilitation, and addressing existing challenges such as small sample sizes and program sustainability. Further research is needed to explore long-term impacts and best practices for optimizing intergenerational engagement.

### **Research Background & Partner Organization**

Given the importance of structured intergenerational engagement as demonstrated in prior research, organizations like Innovation 80 have played a crucial role in implementing these programs at a community level. Innovation 80 is a nonprofit organization in Chicago that funds arts-based programs in underserved communities to foster intergenerational relationships. Through its CoGen initiative, Innovation 80 supports projects that bring together younger and older individuals to collaborate in creative endeavors, promoting mentorship and mutual learning.

Since summer 2023, Innovation 80 has actively expanded its reach, funding thirty-five CoGen projects in collaboration with twenty-two small arts organizations across Chicago. These programs incorporate diverse artistic disciplines such as visual arts, sewing, and music, enabling participants to engage in skill-sharing while strengthening community bonds. For example, the American Indian Center integrates traditional crafts with digital media to preserve cultural heritage, facilitating a cross-mentorship model where elders teach crafting techniques while

youth introduce digital tools (Innovation 80, 2025). Similarly, Architreasures' Our Homes project connects younger individuals with older community members to document local history through oral storytelling and photography (Innovation 80, 2025). Art Encounter's Linking Generations program pairs youth and seniors in Rogers Park for multimedia art projects, fostering cross-generational understanding through interviewing each other to share life experiences (Innovation 80, 2025). Other initiatives, such as The Art of Giving Foundation's cabaret storytelling program and Strands of Wisdom's intergenerational sewing workshops, further demonstrate the range of CoGen-supported efforts that create spaces for collaborative creativity, cultural preservation, and meaningful intergenerational exchanges. These initiatives not only encourage artistic expression but also serve as platforms for cross-generational mentorship, where participants share skills, preserve cultural traditions, and build lasting connections.

### **Program Overview**

In this project, I examined a set of groundbreaking intergenerational arts programs, orchestrated through a strategic collaboration with Innovation 80. This initiative brings together four distinct art organizations in Chicago, each engaging in creative arts to promote intergenerational understanding and strengthen social ties within the community. By analyzing data from pre- and post-program surveys, this study seeks to understand how arts-based activities contribute to social inclusion and cultural dialogue, fostering meaningful interactions across generations.

At the core of this initiative is Connecting Generations (CoGen) (Innovation 80, 2025), a transformative effort that has given rise to five intergenerational programs. While each

participating art organization has its own unique mission—often centered on broader community engagement rather than exclusively intergenerational work—their collaboration within CoGen has created targeted opportunities for cross-generational connection. These programs leverage artistic and historical explorations to foster mutual understanding and respect across different demographic groups, enriching the social and cultural fabric of the community.

The first CoGen connection - *Chicago West Community Music Center (CWCMC)* - was founded in response to the elimination of arts programs in Chicago Public Schools due to budget constraints (Chicago West Community Music Center, 2025). Recognizing the need to fill this gap, particularly in less affluent areas, CWCMC offers high-quality music instruction and community performances aimed at reducing educational disparities in music due to socioeconomic status differences. With support from Innovation 80, the center has launched two focused music programs. The *Reimagining R&B* program connects community members young and old to examine and perform R&B music, exploring its impact on personal lives and broader societal issues, culminating in a performance that showcases their collaborative reinterpretations of classic hits (Chicago West Community Music Center, 2025). The second program was also conducted on Blues music style which immersed participants in the rich tradition of Blues, bringing together individuals from various generations to learn about and perform this genre (Chicago West Community Music Center, 2025).

*Lifting Hearts with the Arts* was established by alumni of Chicago public high schools and is dedicated to leveraging the universal appeal of the arts to bridge generational gaps. Their program, *CoGen Creations*, in collaboration with Innovation 80, pairs high school students with elderly residents from a local care facility (LIFTING HEARTS WITH THE ARTS, 2025). This partnership begins with social gatherings and extends into joint art projects to facilitate open



dialogue and mutual understanding. The program lasted over two academic semesters, allowing relationships to deepen and culminate in a final showcase of their collective artistic expressions.

*Architresures* has spent over two decades transforming public spaces by partnering with under-served communities to promote civic engagement and social connections (Architresures, 2025). Their ongoing effort, *Our Homes*, is an oral history and photography project that documents the stories of the Altgeld Gardens housing community (Architresures, 2025). Supported by Innovation 80, this project pairs young people with older residents to collect and celebrate their shared histories, aiming to instill community pride and strengthen intergenerational bonds.

Lastly, *Art on Sedgwick* aims to utilize art to connect historically disconnected groups within Chicago's Near North side. Their initiative, *Strands of Wisdom*, is a multi-generational sewing program that facilitates interaction between local teens and adults from the Marshall Field Garden Apartments (Art on Sedgwick, 2025). Participants spend weeks exchanging skills and discussing themes like confidence and humility, with the program culminating in a joint art exhibit that highlights their cooperative efforts and strengthens community ties.

### **Data Collection**

As part of the evaluation of the intergenerational arts programs, both young and senior participants were required to complete pre-program and post-program surveys to record their initial expectations and subsequent feelings about their experiences. In both the pre-program and post-program surveys, participants were asked to provide their names, evaluate the difficulty level of relating to another generation, and evaluate the likelihood of a potential collaborative creation based on equal contribution, enjoyment, and pride of the outcome.

There were two sets of true/false questions designed to probe feelings about working across generations. Set A focused on potential issues such as inflexibility, difficulty in understanding, and negative judgments, primarily asked of younger participants in almost all pre- and post-program surveys. Set B, on the other hand, addressed issues like language barriers, lack of interest in intergenerational relationships, and difficulties in understanding perspectives, typically directed at older participants. However, in the pre-program survey for the *Strands of Wisdom* program, all participants were asked questions from Set B.

In addition, the post-program survey included more items to assess the direct impact of the program. Participants were asked to fill out their attendance, rate the meaningfulness of the program, and assess how it influenced their views and interactions with other generations. Moreover, the post-program survey included three open-ended questions to provide straightforward insights into the participants' personal experiences and the qualitative impact of the program, allowing for a richer understanding of how intergenerational arts activities can foster mutual respect and cultural enrichment. These questions were 1. "What was the most impactful aspect of the program for you?"; 2. "How has this program changed your perception of other generations?"; 3. "Can you describe a memorable interaction that occurred during the program?"

### **Data Pre-Management and Encoding**

All surveys were initially collected on paper. To facilitate easier access and analysis in the future, these were digitized and stored electronically (167 by 23). During this process, several data encoding and management challenges emerged due to the surveys' inconsistent handwriting and naming conventions. Some participants only provided a first name, while others offered initials, leading to inconsistencies in identifying participants. Consequently, we decided to treat

individuals in the pre- and post-surveys as different participants to ensure data integrity. Moreover, participation between pre- and post-surveys across all programs, including the West R&B program, was notably unstable. For example, in the “West BLUES” program, there were 21 participants for pre-program surveys, including 10 seniors and 11 young participants whereas there were only 11 records from young generations for post-program surveys.

In addition, for those true/false questions, responses where participants selected both "Yes" and "No" or wrote "Maybe" were considered invalid and excluded from the analysis. Furthermore, the response format for certain questions varied between surveys. For example, questions about the likelihood of various aspects of a potential collaborative creation used a 1-5 Likert scale in the pre-survey but was a binary Yes/No in the post-survey. To maintain consistency, we re-coded "Yes" as 5 and "No" as 0, converting binary responses into continuous data. For the final question on the number of meetings attended, we re-coded responses for better clarity: 'All' was coded as 0, 'All but one' as 1, 'All but two' as 2, and 'Unfortunately, I had to miss more than two' as 3. Regarding open-ended questions, blank responses were left as such, "IDK" (I don't know) responses were recorded verbatim, and "N/A" (not applicable) was also transcribed as "No" to preserve the intent of the respondent.

### **Analyses**

The approach to analyzing data from the intergenerational programs was structured to provide a comprehensive evaluation of their effectiveness. The analysis progressed from basic descriptive visualizations to more sophisticated statistical and computational analyses, ensuring a thorough assessment of participant responses across various program dimensions. This structured quantitative and computational analytical strategy allowed for a robust examination of how the programs influenced participants' perceptions and experiences.

### ***Descriptive Data***

Initially, histograms and density plots were employed to visualize the distribution of responses (Fiveable, 2024), focusing on participants' ratings of program meaningfulness, collaboration enjoyment, and pride in outcomes. These visual representations compared responses between younger and older participants and between pre- and post- programs, providing a foundational overview of generational and attitudinal differences in program perceptions.

### ***Binary Data***

For true/false questions collected in pre- and post-program surveys, Chi-Square tests of independence were conducted to assess whether response distributions significantly changed over time. This statistical test is widely used for analyzing categorical data, particularly when examining changes in proportions across independent groups or time points (Field, 2017). In the context of this study, it was applied to determine whether program participation influenced attitudes toward intergenerational collaboration, flexibility, and perspective-taking.

### ***Scale Data***

Paired t-tests were used to analyze Likert scale responses related to collaboration enjoyment and pride in outcomes. These tests compared pre- and post-program responses to detect significant attitudinal shifts and also examined differences between younger and senior participants to explore potential generational effects. Paired t-tests are appropriate for repeated-measures data, where the same participants provide responses at two different time points (pre- and post- program), making them a standard method for detecting changes in attitudes or perceptions over time (Field, 2017).

Besides that, Spearman's rank correlation was conducted to examine the relationship between attendance frequency and perceived meaningfulness ratings. Since attendance was recorded as an ordinal variable, Spearman's correlation was chosen over Pearson's correlation to account for non-parametric data and potential non-linear relationships (Conover, 1999). This analysis aimed to assess whether the number of sessions attended influenced participants' perceived value of the program.

### ***Textual Data***

To analyze open-ended survey responses, text processing techniques were applied using tidytext in R (Silge & Robinson, 2024). This involved tokenizing responses, removing common stopwords, and calculating word frequencies to identify recurring themes in participant reflections. Further, a sentiment analysis was performed using R to categorize responses as positive, negative, or neutral. Considering the text responses for this project is quite thin, a lexicon based sentiment analysis was adopted (Bulut, 2025) This analysis was designed to assess the emotional tone of participant reflections, providing deeper insights into how participants subjectively experienced the program beyond structured survey responses.

## **Results**

### ***Descriptive Analysis***

To evaluate participants' experiences in the intergenerational programs, an analysis of meaningfulness ratings, collaboration enjoyment, and pride in program outcomes was conducted. The density plots, Figure 1 (Appendix A), revealed that senior participants rated the programs as more meaningful compared to younger participants, with a pronounced peak at the highest

meaningfulness score of 5. In contrast, younger participants showed a broader distribution of meaningfulness scores, suggesting a wider variation in their perceptions of program impact.

The changes in distributions of collaboration enjoyment and pride in outcome scores revealed a strong shift in participant responses from the pre-program to the post-program phase, as shown in Figure 2 and Figure 3 (Appendix A). Before participation, responses for both variables were more varied, with ratings spread across the scale from 1 to 5. Whereas, after participation, ratings were overwhelmingly at the highest level (score = 5), which indicates a significant increase in positive experiences.

### ***Binary Data Analysis***

To assess changes in intergenerational perceptions from a statistical perspective, chi-square tests were conducted on binary data of pre- and post-program survey responses. One of the most notable findings was that, when comparing young participants' attitude toward perceived understanding from senior participants between pre and post programs, there were significantly more young participants who believed that seniors could understand their perspectives after the program ( $X^2 = 10.35$ ,  $df = 1$ ,  $p = .001$ ) (Figure 9, Appendix A). While there were more senior participants who believed young people could understand them, the results were not significant ( $X^2 = 1.3652$ ,  $df = 1$ ,  $p = 0.2426$ ) (Figure 4, Appendix A). This result suggests that structured intergenerational interactions helped challenge and reshape initial assumptions about seniors' perceived ability to relate to younger generations and juniors' perceived understanding from older generations.

Additionally, as shown in Figure 5 (Appendix A), senior participants exhibited a significant reduction in their perception that young participants were uninterested in engaging

with them ( $X^2 = 6.87$ ,  $df = 1$ ,  $p = .009$ ). This result indicates that direct engagement in intergenerational programs helped dismantle stereotypes held by seniors regarding young participants' willingness to interact.

Although young participants' perception of seniors' inflexibility showed a decline after program participation as shown in Figure 6 (Appendix A), this shift was not statistically significant ( $X^2 = 3.43$ ,  $df = 1$ ,  $p = .064$ ). This suggests that while the programs encouraged more positive attitudes toward intergenerational collaboration, some pre-existing stereotypes persisted. One possible explanation for the lack of statistical significance could be the duration of the program, as attitude shifts regarding deeply ingrained stereotypes may require longer-term exposure and repeated interactions. Additionally, the relatively small sample size may have limited statistical power, making it more challenging to detect significant changes.

Furthermore, a correlation analysis of attendance and meaningfulness was conducted to see if attending more sessions of the program correlates with perceived meaningfulness. Unfortunately, there was no significant association between the number of sessions attended and perceived meaningfulness ( $\rho = -0.06$ ,  $p = .62$ ). This finding suggests that the frequency of participation did not strongly predict meaningfulness ratings. While this could indicate that the depth and nature of engagement are more critical than sheer attendance, it is also possible that other factors—such as participant expectations, session structure, or prior attitudes—played a role in shaping perceptions of meaningfulness.

### ***Scale Data Analysis***

Welch's two-sample t-tests were conducted to compare pre- and post-program ratings of collaboration enjoyment and pride in program outcomes. As shown in Figure 7 and 8 (Appendix

A), both collaboration enjoyment ratings and pride in outcome ratings increased significantly after program participation, ( $t = -6.21$ ,  $df = 85$ ,  $p < .001$ ) ( $t = -5.82$ ,  $df = 85$ ,  $p < .001$ ). These findings show that, in both generations, participants' expected joy and pride in working with another generation were greatly boosted through the program, and they highlight the program's effectiveness in fostering meaningful engagement and rewarding collaborative experiences across generations.

Comparisons between younger and senior participants on these measures revealed no significant differences. Although the mean scores of collaboration enjoyment and pride in outcome for young participants were slightly higher than those of senior participants, collaboration enjoyment did not differ significantly between the two age groups ( $t = -1.52$ ,  $df = 104.27$ ,  $p = .131$ ), and pride in outcome also showed no significant difference between groups ( $t = -1.68$ ,  $df = 107.85$ ,  $p = .096$ ). These results suggest that both generations found the programs similarly engaging and rewarding.

### ***Textual Data Analysis***

To further examine participants' qualitative experiences, a text analysis of open-ended survey responses was conducted. The most frequently mentioned words combining all five programs included "learn," "fun," "together," "surprised," and "experience," highlighting participants' reflected the education's meaning and the excitement of learning new things and engaging in enjoyable activities. Across different programs, distinct thematic patterns emerged: West BLUES and West R&B programs prominently featured music and creativity. LHA program's top 10 frequent words include "relate", "community", and "connect" highlight the emphasis on building connections through storytelling and historical exploration, while Our



Homes program's words "Learn", "younger", and "history" indicate an intergenerational exchange where participants explored historical narratives together. Similarly, Strands of Wisdom program responses often included words like "surprised", "creative", and "relationships," indicating a strong sense of discovery and appreciation for intergenerational interactions. These findings align with the structured program activities designed to promote collaborative learning and cultural exchange.

A sentiment analysis further revealed that the vast majority of responses conveyed positive emotional tones, supporting the quantitative findings that participants found the programs enjoyable, meaningful, and impactful. Programs like West BLUES and West R&B were characterized by high positive sentiment scores. Notably, Strands of Wisdom exhibited the highest overall sentiment score, with minimal negative sentiment, suggesting that this program resonated strongly with participants. Results of dominant positive emotions from participants' answers indicate the effectiveness of the programs on creative collaboration fostered particularly engaging experiences. However, it is important to note that a higher sentiment score does not necessarily indicate that Strands of Wisdom was the most effective or successful program. The observed pattern may be attributed to a larger number of participants in this program or more elaborate responses in the qualitative data, rather than an objective measure of program effectiveness.

Additionally, sentiment scores differed between seniors and younger participants. Seniors tended to express higher net positive sentiment than younger participants, indicating that they found the programs especially meaningful and fulfilling. Younger participants, while also responding positively, exhibited greater variability in their sentiment scores, possibly reflecting a wider range of expectations and experiences.

Overall, these findings suggest that structured intergenerational programs can enhance collaboration experiences, foster intergenerational empathy, and reduce negative perceptions between generations. The significant improvement in young participants' understanding of seniors, combined with seniors' increased willingness to engage with younger individuals, underscores the effectiveness of these programs in fostering cross-generational connections and mutual appreciation.

To further explore these findings, an interactive Shiny App was developed, allowing users to engage with the data dynamically. This platform provides an accessible way to visualize descriptive statistics, attitudinal shifts, and sentiment analysis results, enabling users to filter data and compare trends. The interactive Shiny App presentation of the plots and interpretations in this section could be checked via this [link](#).

### **Recommendation**

The findings suggest that attitudinal changes did occur, particularly in expectations of the joy and pride from collaborating between generations, how young participants perceived seniors' ability to understand their perspectives, and in seniors' increased willingness to engage with younger individuals. However, certain stereotypes persisted, especially regarding seniors' flexibility, and attendance was not significantly correlated with perceived meaningfulness. Additionally, seniors reported more positive sentiment than younger participants, highlighting potential differences in how each age group experiences intergenerational engagement. These insights suggest that while the programs were successful in fostering meaningful interactions, there is room to further refine engagement strategies and program evaluation methods.

To better assess participant experiences and address areas for improvement, Innovation 80 should implement a structured feedback survey focusing on program satisfaction, expectations, and engagement levels. This can provide targeted insights into what aspects of the program are most effective and what areas may require refinement. Also, since younger participants may have different motivations and engagement preferences, gathering specific feedback on activity design can help ensure that sessions remain relevant and appealing to both age groups. Sample questions listed below (more questions could be checked in Appendix B):

1. *Did the program meet your expectations?*
2. *Would you participate again? Why or why not?*
3. *Which activities were most meaningful to you?*

In addition to feedback on program satisfaction, integrating an empathy assessment adapted from Davis (1980) would allow Innovation 80 to measure changes in intergenerational understanding and assess whether participation fosters greater perspective-taking. There are seven questions in total (seen in Appendix C), including “*It is easy for me to see things from an older person’s (or younger person’s) point of view*”, “*I try to look at both sides of a disagreement before making a decision*”, and “*Before criticizing somebody, I try to imagine how I would feel if I were in their place*”. Participants will be asked to rate from 1 to 5 which represent from *Never* to *Always*, and the final empathy score will be the total scores of 7 questions. This could provide deeper insight into how attitudes evolve throughout the program. Since reducing intergenerational biases is a key objective, tracking empathy levels before and after program participation would allow Innovation 80 to determine whether the structure of its initiatives is effectively fostering greater understanding and mutual respect.

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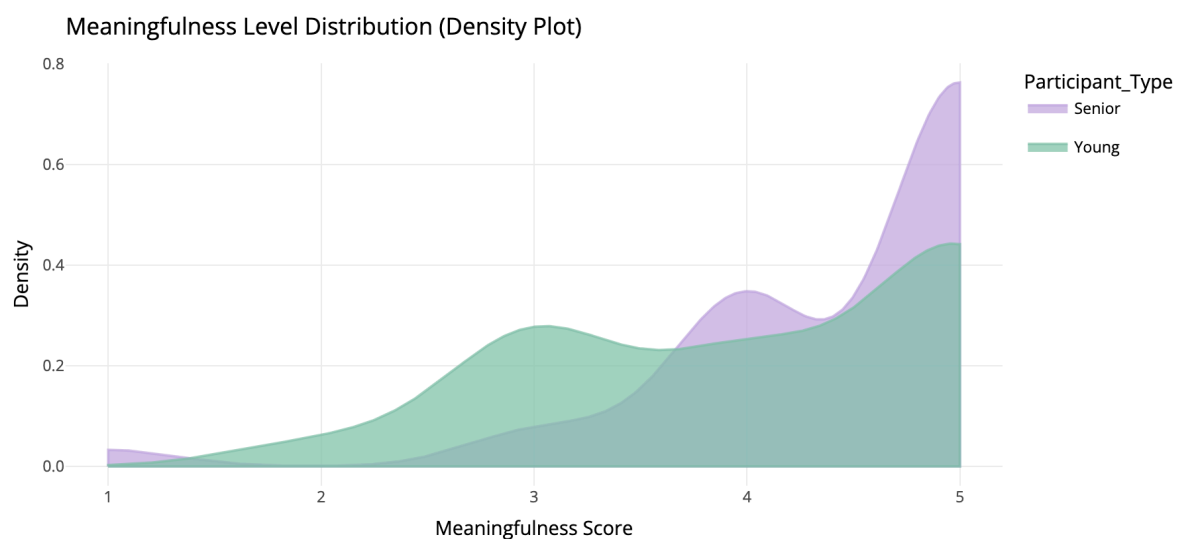
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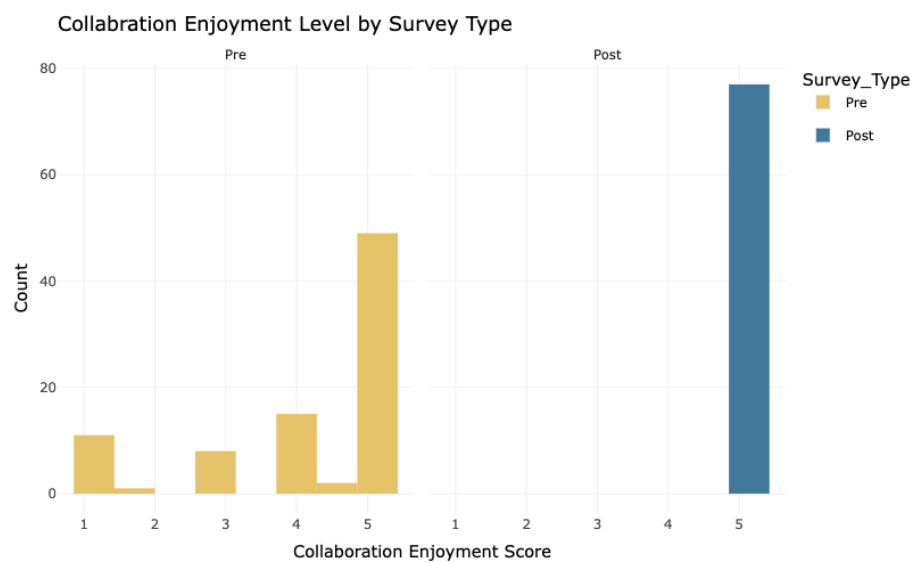
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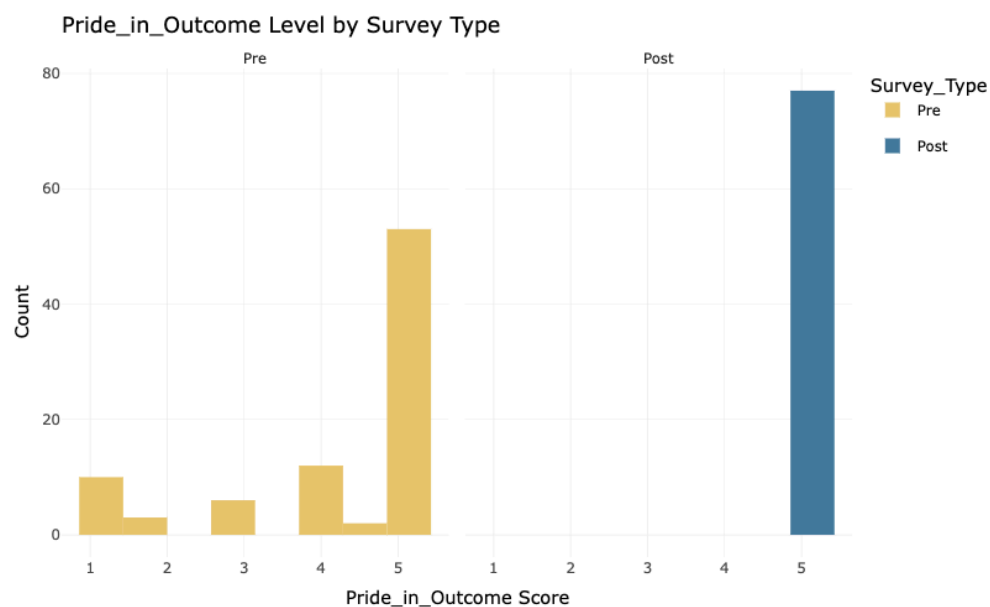
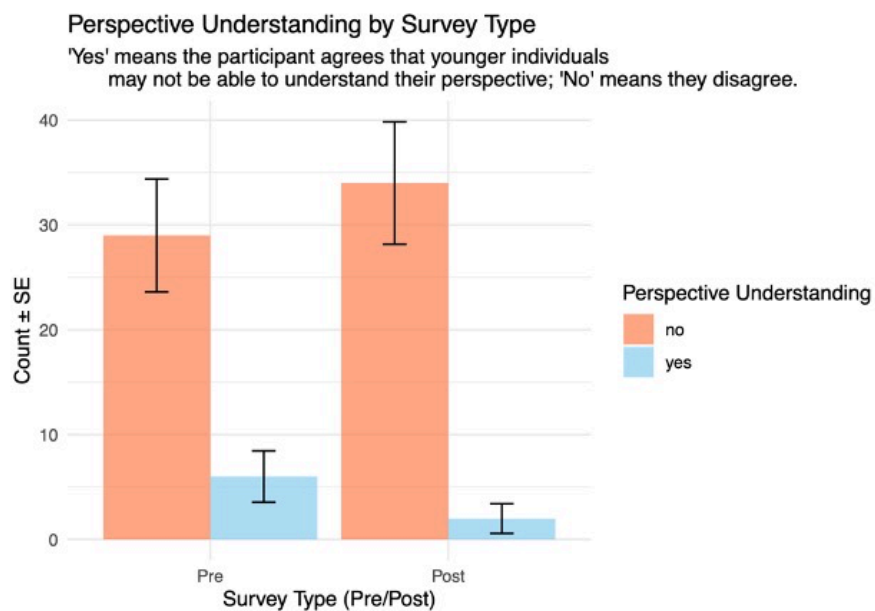
## Appendix A

**Figure 1:**

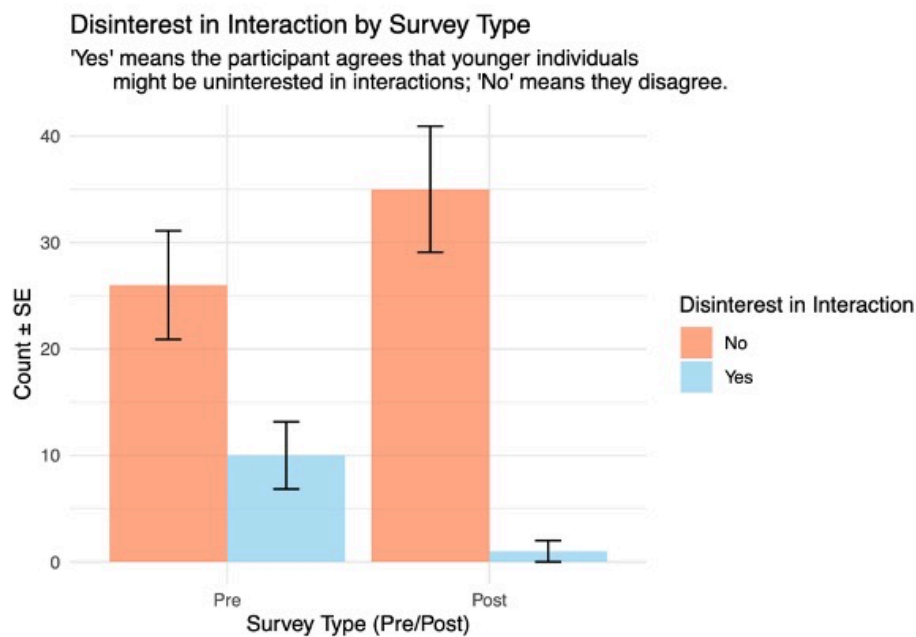
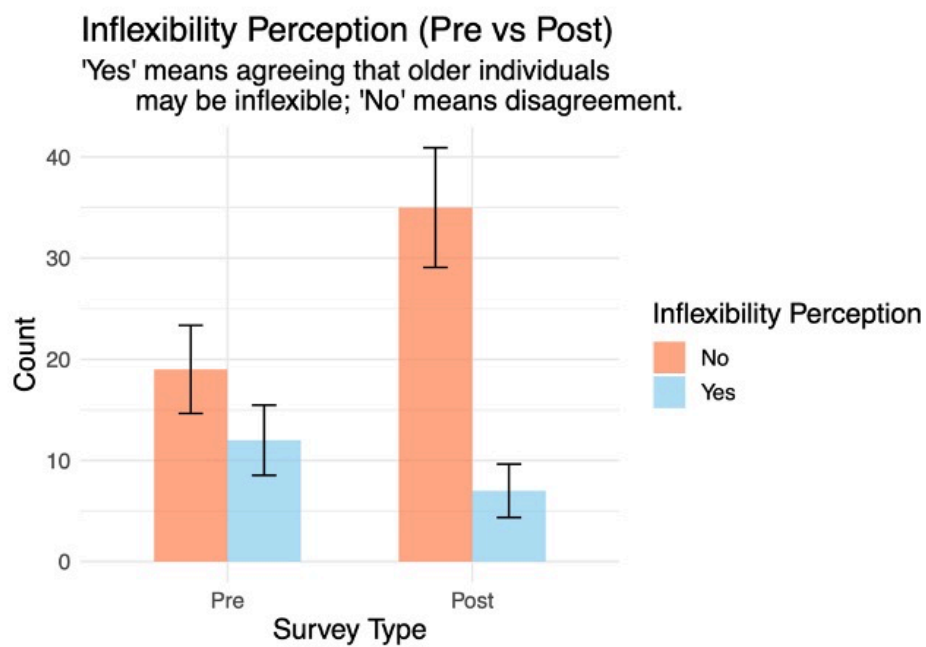


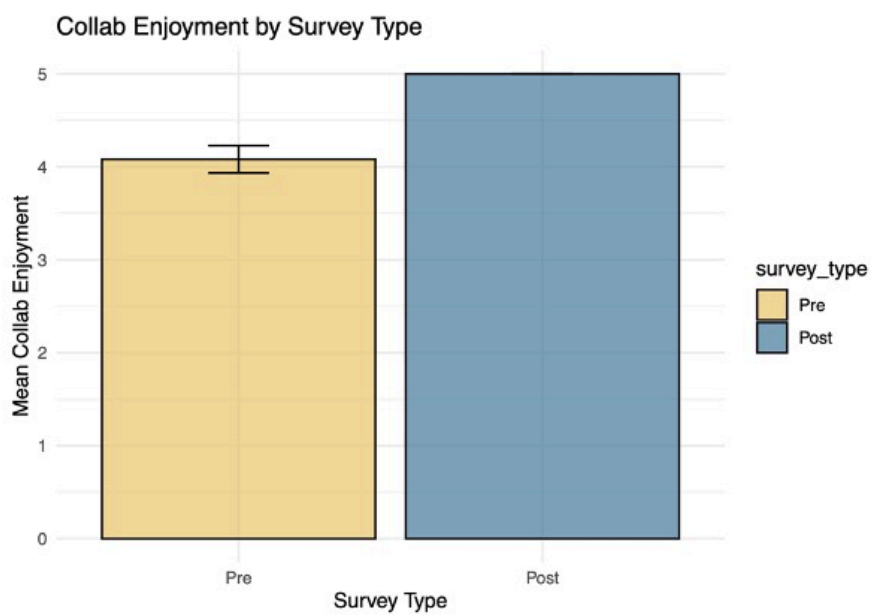
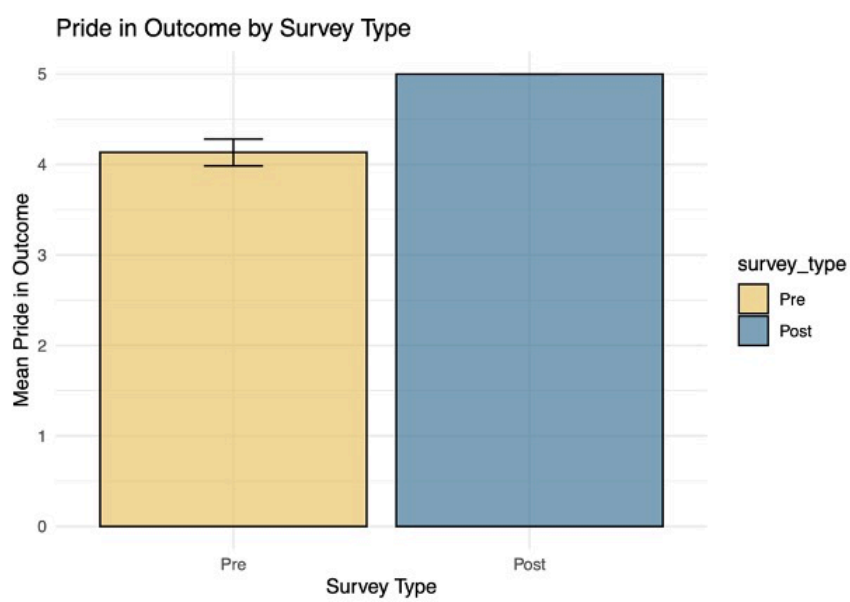
**Figure 2:**



**Figure 3:****Figure 4:**

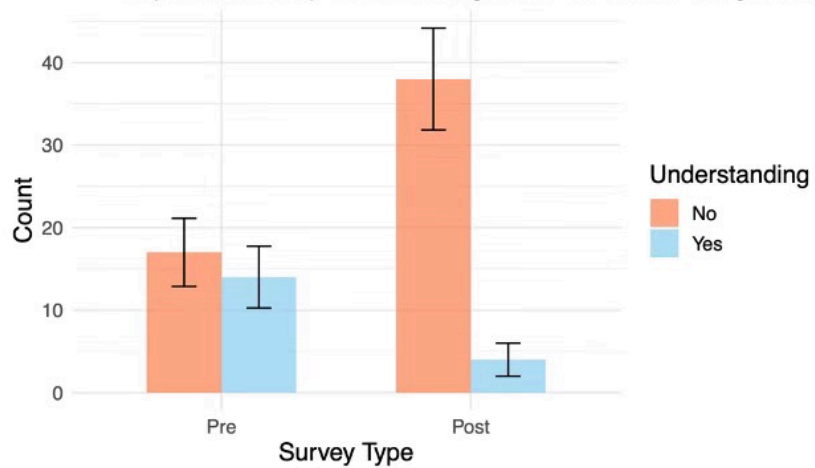


**Figure 5:****Figure 6:**

**Figure 7:****Figure 8:**

**Figure 9:**

**Understanding (Pre vs Post) Among Young Participants**  
'Yes' means agreeing that older individuals  
may have difficulty understanding them; 'No' means disagreeing



## Appendix B

### ***Program Feedback Survey:***

1. Did you enjoy this program? *(Please circle one)*

- (5) Very Satisfied
- (4) Satisfied
- (3) Neither Satisfied nor Dissatisfied
- (2) Dissatisfied
- (1) Very Dissatisfied

2. Did the program meet your expectations?

- Yes
  - No
  - *If no, please explain:*
- 

3. Would you participate in this program again?

- Yes
- No
- I don't know

4. Why or why not?

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5. What did you like about this program? *(Check all that apply)*

- ☐ Meeting new people
- ☐ Socializing with others
- ☐ Getting out of my home
- ☐ Program content or topic
- ☐ Food
- ☐ Other: \_\_\_\_\_

## Appendix C

### *Empathy Questionnaire:*

Please describe how frequently you feel or act in the manner described.

1. It is easy for me to see things from an older person's (or younger person's) point of view.
  - (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often
  - (5) Always
2. I try to look at everybody's side of a disagreement before I make a decision.
  - (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often
  - (5) Always
3. I sometimes try to understand older people (or younger people) by imagining how things look from their perspective.
  - (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often
  - (5) Always
4. Even if I am right about something, I still listen to other people's opinions.
  - (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often
  - (5) Always
5. I believe that there are two sides to every question and try to look at them both.
  - (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often

- (5) Always
6. When I am bothered by someone, I usually try to “put myself in his/her shoes” for a while.
- (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often
  - (5) Always
7. Before criticizing somebody, I try to imagine how I would feel if I were in his or her place.
- (1) Never
  - (2) Rarely
  - (3) Sometimes
  - (4) Often
  - (5) Always